2 Rajput had spent three years in Walong, building and siting the defences on either flank of the Lohit. The Rajputs, who were to move to Mathura after their two-and-a-half year tenure, handed over to 6 Kumaon, under the command of Lieutenant Colonel C. N. Madiah, towards the end of March 1962. Eastern Command ordered the setting up of three new posts on the surrounding heights, each of which was at an altitude of over 9,800 feet. The first of these guarded the entrance to the Chu Valley and was situated sixteen kilometres west of Kibithu. The Chu post had its own DZ, while the other two new posts were in the Di Chu Valley and had a common DZ. Two additional platoons from 7 Assam Rifles (based in Jairampur) had to be flown in to man these new posts tucked away in the watershed between India and Burma. To further facilitate these changes, a second wing of the Assam Rifles was set up at Hot Springs.

Even before tension started to build up over the Dhola post on the Nam Ka Chu at the other end of NEFA, forward observation posts of the Assam Rifles started reporting a heavy build-up on the Chinese side near both Sama and Rima. Madiah was ordered by Brigadier G. S. Gill, commander of 5 Infantry Brigade, to move to Kibithu with his Tac HQ along with Charlie Company. He would function as the Kibithu sub-sector commander. Madiah immediately decided to deploy Alpha Company on the Dichu Ridge. Bravo Company was ordered to move to the East Ridge while Delta Company was also asked to move out of Walong and take up positions near The Ladders.

Alpha and Bravo Companies of 4 Sikh had started to fly into Walong by end September to fill the void created by the sudden advance of 6 Kumaon to set up the new posts. This battalion, hitherto a part of 62 Infantry Brigade, had moved from Ramgarh to Jorhat along with 2/8 GR, where it was placed under the command of 5 Infantry Brigade. The commanding officer of 4 Sikh, Lieutenant Colonel A. Behl, was appointed the Walong sub-sector commander. Alpha Company was asked to deploy in the Dong area while Bravo took up position on the Maha Plateau with one platoon at The Ladders.

The headlong rush of 6 Kumaon towards Kibithu the moment reports of the Chinese build-up started coming in underlines the lack of cohesive thinking even in early October 1962. The concept of Thorat’s defensive line, spelt out so lucidly in Exercise Lal Qila, had obviously not permeated beyond the four walls of the conference room in Lucknow. Brigadier Gill,